

BEL AND THE DRAGON

¹ And king Astyages was gathered to his fathers, and Cyrus of Persia received his kingdom.

² And Daniel conversed with the king, and was honored above all his friends.

³ Now the Babylonians had an idol, called Bel, and there were spent upon him every day twelve great measures of fine flour, and forty sheep, and six vessels of wine.

⁴ And the king worshipped it and went daily to adore it: but Daniel worshipped his own God. And the king said to him, Why do not you worship Bel?

⁵ Who answered and said, Because I may not worship idols made with hands, but the living God, who has created the heaven and the earth, and has sovereignty over all flesh.

⁶ Then said the king to him, Thinkest you not that Bel is a living God? see you not how much he eats and drinks every day?

⁷ Then Daniel smiled, and said, O king, be not deceived: for this is but clay within, and brass without, and did never eat or drink any thing.

⁸ So the king was angry, and called for his priests, and said to them, If you ^ tell me not who this is that devours these expenses, you ^ shall die.

⁹ But if you ^ can certify me that Bel devours them, then Daniel shall die: for he has spoken

blasphemy against Bel. And Daniel said to the king, Let it be according to your word.

¹⁰ Now the priests of Bel were threescore and ten, beside their wives and children. And the king went with Daniel into the temple of Bel.

¹¹ So Bel's priests said, Behold, we go out: but you, O king, set on the meat, and make ready the wine, and shut the door fast and seal it with your own signet;

¹² And to morrow when you come in, if you find not that Bel has eaten up all, we will suffer death: or else Daniel, that speaks falsely against us.

¹³ And they little regarded it: for under the table they had made a privy entrance, whereby they entered in continually, and consumed those things.

¹⁴ So when they were gone forth, the king set meats before Bel. Now Daniel had commanded his servants to bring ashes, and those they strewed throughout all the temple in the presence of the king alone: then they went out, and shut the door, and sealed it with the king's signet, and so departed.

¹⁵ Now in the night came the priests with their wives and children, as they were wont to do, and did eat and drink up all.

¹⁶ In the morning betime the king arose, and Daniel with him.

¹⁷ And the king said, Daniel, are the seals whole? And he said, Yes, O king, they be whole.

¹⁸ And as soon as he had opened the door, the king looked upon the table, and cried with a loud

voice, Great are you, O Bel, and with you is no deceit at all.

¹⁹ Then laughed Daniel, and held the king that he should not go in, and said, Behold now the pavement, and mark well whose footsteps are these.

²⁰ And the king said, I see the footsteps of men, women, and children. And then the king was angry,

²¹ And took the priests with their wives and children, who showed him the privy doors, where they came in, and consumed such things as were upon the table.

²² Therefore the king killed them, and delivered Bel into Daniel's power, who destroyed him and his temple.

²³ And in that same place there was a great dragon, which they of Babylon worshipped.

²⁴ And the king said to Daniel, Will you also say that this is of brass? behold, he lives, he eats and drinks; you can not say that he is no living god: therefore worship him.

²⁵ Then said Daniel to the king, I will worship the Lord my God: for he is the living God.

²⁶ But give me leave, O king, and I shall kill this dragon without sword or staff. The king said, I give you leave.

²⁷ Then Daniel took pitch, and fat, and hair, and did seethe them together, and made lumps thereof: this he put in the dragon's mouth, and so the dragon burst in sunder: and Daniel said, Behold, these are the gods you ^ worship.

²⁸ When they of Babylon heard that, they

took great indignation, and conspired against the king, saying, The king is become a Jew, and he has destroyed Bel, he has slain the dragon, and put the priests to death.

²⁹ So they came to the king, and said, Deliver us Daniel, or else we will destroy you and your house.

³⁰ Now when the king saw that they pressed him sore, being constrained, he delivered Daniel to them:

³¹ Who cast him into the lions' den: where he was six days.

³² And in the den there were seven lions, and they had given them every day two carcasses, and two sheep: which then were not given to them, to the intent they might devour Daniel.

³³ Now there was in Jewry a prophet, called Habbacuc, who had made pottage, and had broken bread in a bowl, and was going into the field, for to bring it to the reapers.

³⁴ But the angel of the Lord said to Habbacuc, Go, carry the dinner that you have into Babylon to Daniel, who is in the lions' den.

³⁵ And Habbacuc said, Lord, I never saw Babylon; neither do I know where the den is.

³⁶ Then the angel of the Lord took him by the crown, and bare him by the hair of his head, and through the vehemency of his spirit set him in Babylon over the den.

³⁷ And Habbacuc cried, saying, O Daniel, Daniel, take the dinner which God has sent you.

³⁸ And Daniel said, You have remembered me, O God: neither have you forsaken them that seek

you and love you.

³⁹ So Daniel arose, and did eat: and the angel of the Lord set Habbacuc in his own place again immediately.

⁴⁰ Upon the seventh day the king went to bewail Daniel: and when he came to the den, he looked in, and behold, Daniel was sitting.

⁴¹ Then cried the king with a loud voice, saying, Great are you Lord God of Daniel, and there is none other beside you.

⁴² And he drew him out, and cast those that were the cause of his destruction into the den: and they were devoured in a moment before his face.

LXX2012: Septuagint in American English 2012

**The Septuagint with Apocrypha, translated from
Greek to English by Sir Lancelot C. L. Brenton and
published in 1885, with some language updates
(American English)**

Public Domain

Language: English

Dialect (if applicable): American

Language in English: English

Translation by:

Sir Lancelot Charles Lee Brenton

Michael Paul Johnson

LXX2012: Septuagint in English 2012

This is a translation of the Old Testament and Apocrypha/Deuterocanon from Hebrew to Greek to 19th Century British English, with some updates of spelling and word usage to contemporary American English. The original English translation was done by Sir Lancelot Charles Lee Brenton and published by Samuel Bagster & Sons, Ltd., in London in 1851. It has entered the Public Domain due to the passage of sufficient time. In the process of scanning and typing the text, the original poetry and prose formatting, as well as peripheral material like introductions and notes, have been omitted.

This edition of the Septuagint has some language updates. Brenton's word order and punctuation has been mostly retained, meaning that quotation marks are not used, and sentences within quotes may not start with capital letters, as was standard usage in 1851. Names transliterated from Greek to those transliterated from Hebrew in the common English Bibles often differ. These language updates are dedicated to the Public Domain by the author of those edits, Michael Paul Johnson. Therefore this edition may be freely copied, published, etc.

Before considering making changes to the text of this work, I recommend that you consult with God, because this is really His Book.

If you find errors in the text, please report them so that we can correct them.

Donations to help with the expenses of operating this web site and thus

help others have free access to the Word of God may be made to us, but are not required. Please see <http://MLJohnson.org/partner/> for more about that.

PDF generated using Haiola and XeLaTeX on 22 Dec 2025 from source files dated 13 Dec 2025
6f50e273-f243-52ef-a4e1-de7ba198eeb3